

HOUSE No. 2299

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Kristin E. Kassner

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act regarding land use board training.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	DATE ADDED:
<i>Kristin E. Kassner</i>	<i>2nd Essex</i>	<i>1/16/2025</i>
<i>Vanna Howard</i>	<i>17th Middlesex</i>	<i>3/7/2025</i>
<i>Mark D. Sylvia</i>	<i>10th Bristol</i>	<i>5/15/2025</i>

HOUSE No. 2299

By Representative Kassner of Hamilton, a petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 2299) of Kristin E. Kassner and Vanna Howard relative to education and training for members of local planning boards and zoning boards of appeals. Municipalities and Regional Government.

[SIMILAR MATTER FILED IN PREVIOUS SESSION
SEE HOUSE, NO. 3553 OF 2023-2024.]

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act regarding land use board training.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 Section 3 of chapter 23B of the General Laws, as appearing in the 2022 Official Edition,
2 is hereby amended by inserting after clause (v) the following subsection:- (w) establish, conduct
3 and maintain an annual program of education, self-evaluation, and training for members of local
4 planning boards, special permit granting authorities, and zoning boards of appeals, at no cost to
5 municipalities; provided, however, that the department shall consult with the Massachusetts
6 Association of Planning Directors, Massachusetts Association of Regional Planning Agencies,
7 and American Planning Association - Massachusetts Chapter, and Massachusetts Citizen Planner
8 Training Collaborative regarding development of the program to provide such education, self-
9 evaluation, and training. Training shall cover special permits, subdivision control, variances, fair
10 housing and any other laws that govern the role and responsibility of said board. To the extent

11 practicable, the education, self-evaluation, and training programs shall be offered online and in
12 various locations throughout the commonwealth, at various times of the year.

13 Every member of local planning boards, special permit granting authorities, and zoning
14 boards of appeals shall, within 60 days after becoming a board member, and every 2 years
15 thereafter, complete the education, self-evaluation, and training program, either online or in-
16 person. Upon completion of the program, the member shall provide notice of such completion to
17 the town or city clerk, such notice to be retained for 6 years.